Design opportunity

- Awareness gaps
- Coordination complexity
- Social risk in raising it directly
- timing/context mismatch
- Repeated small friction (like no conversation)
- Something that can enhance an experience (make it more inviting, fun) not necessarily trying to find a solution/problem

Ideas

- Vegetarian/vegan students eating with mixed diet friend groups?
- Share-house dynamics where people eat/exercise differently: cooperation/coordination, meal timing, kitchen use
- Grocery shopping/menu coordination in share houses
- Study/exam periods ruining eating and exercise routines for people
- Couples with mismatched work/uni schedules maintaining exercise and shared meals???
- Housemates who work night shifts missing out on the eating/exercise timing
- Injury affecting friend group (can't go out to eat/exercise with the friend group
- Newbies gym goers more inviting and not feeling embarrassed
- Make earning a meal after exercise celebratory/more social
- Make new playful traditions with friend groups (or just other groups) like trying out new restaurant/foods every week or something like that)
- Digital tools to promote healthier habits in the workplace
- **Utilizing social media to influence the food/health choices people make**
- Social media makes healthy living look easy, but people struggle to translate idealised online lifestyles into realistic everyday habits
- Activity matching by mood — users choose chill / social / energetic / outdoors and find an appropriate activity.
- Diet tracking and dietary/health goal planner with AI – Provides recommendations on what to eat based on physique, calorie intake, and dietary goals.

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Ideas after week 3

- Group meal planning for sustainability
- Household food waste

How do people determine which nutrition information on social media to trust when making food choices?

How can social media promote realistic and sustainable healthy choices rather than idealised lifestyles that are difficult for ordinary people to maintain?

How does social media influence people's everyday food choices, and what prevents online inspiration from becoming healthier eating behaviour?

People are highly exposed to healthy food content on social media, but there is a gap between being inspired by that content and consistently acting on it in everyday life.

Sustainable and healthy are two different things

- Healthy choices focus on personal physical and mental well-being, while sustainable choices focus on protecting the earth and its natural resources

Think of a social technology in this context like think of it as where and when are people making sustainable / healthy food choices.

What actually influences people's choice when making healthy choices or sustainable choices?

- Culture, prices, diet, allergies, wants, needs, health, convenience, habit, taste, the people around them, knowledge, awareness,

What influences then when they make negative or unhealthy choices.

- Culture, prices, wants, convenience, habit, people around them and more importantly taste

(buying groceries, online shopping, etc.) - food delivery apps

Potentailly instead of changing their ways, can maybe give awareness to the habits/choices

Then we can see how we can insert technology into this domain to help understand the concept

Would people be willing to change the way they make choices in terms of food/health choices. Stubborn, maybe not willing to change at all

A Survey on Healthy Food Decision Influences Through Technological Innovations: A Survey on Healthy Food Decision Influences Through Technological Innovations | ACM Transactions on Computing for Healthcare

- focus on healthy food choice technologies to gain insight on what factors have been considered when recommending nutrition-related information to consumers

- **Person-related factors: "biological (e.g., sensory perception (taste, aversion and physical health), demographic (e.g., cultural characteristics), psychological (e.g.,**

health cognitions, food habits, and social influence and support), and situational (e.g., situational and time constraints)"

- **how important implied taste of a product can be for the user regardless of healthiness and that the taste factor should be strongly considered**

- **Properties of the food: nutritious composition**
  - **the recommendation process can be manipulated such that consumers may choose a healthier recipe more often**
  - **how consumers cannot effectively distinguish between recipes that have significantly more fat than another similar recipes when relying only on images**
  - **created "Foodle," an interface that presented users with goal-driven food recommendations after analyzing the product list gathered from the grocery receipts. The recommendations are based on the gap in nutrition between the current purchase and a nutrition target**
  - **utilized grocery shopping receipts to create a visualization that displayed a food pyramid and nutrition information of the purchased items. This fosters reflection about consumer shopping habits, which aids families in adopting healthier foods choices.**
- **Environmental factors: micro and macro variables related to consumers, food, and their environment. Stok et al. [62] define micro variables as being influenced by people (e.g., food portion sizes and eating environment). They describe macro variables as being related to the consumers' surroundings, which may be beyond their control (e.g., environment availability, food accessibility, market prices, and characteristics of living area).**
  - **Portion size: limiting food portions**
  - **Environment food availability, accessibility, and market prices refer to geographic location and socioeconomic status of a community, which can influence the access and cost of healthy food**
  - **Eating environment refers to the social/personal surroundings of the consumer. Takeuchi et al. [64] considered users' meal satisfaction/preferences and eating environment to improve the user's eating habits**
- **What they found out**
  - **Person-Related Factors is an area that could be researched further specifically**

Envisioning Future Food, Technology, and Health: Teens' Perspectives Through Design Fiction: [Envisioning Future Food, Technology, and Health: Teens' Perspectives Through Design Fiction | Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems]

Building a resilient, sustainable, and **healthier food** supply **through innovation** and **technology**

Reddit's Appetite: Predicting User Engagement with Nutritional Content Something something user engagement. High calorie food sees more engagement or sum shi
A Survey on Healthy Food Decision Influences Through Technological Innovations cbs reading. I summarise later.

Strategies to Promote Healthy Eating Among University Students: A Qualitative Study Using the Nominal Group Technique

The paper investigates why university students struggle to maintain a healthy diet and what could help them make healthier choices. Using group discussions with 39 students aged 19-26, it found that the main barriers were **limited money, high prices of healthy food, lack of time, poor nutrition knowledge, lack of motivation, and negative social influences**. These barriers were especially relevant to students who were new to university and had less experience with shopping and preparing food. Students suggested strategies such as **cheaper healthy food, supermarket discounts, better food options, and more useful nutrition information**. Overall, the paper shows that healthy eating is influenced by a mix of **personal, financial, social and environmental factors**, meaning that simply giving students more nutritional information may not be enough.

Purpose: Find out what makes healthy eating difficult for university students and what could help.
Participants: 39 university students aged **19–26**.
Main barriers:

- High price of healthy food
- Limited money
- Lack of time
- Poor nutrition/food knowledge
- Lack of motivation or willpower
- Negative social influence

Important finding: First-year students had less experience with **food shopping, food preparation and purchasing decisions**.
Suggested solutions: Supermarket discounts, cheaper healthy food, better food options, and nutrition education.
Key takeaway: Healthy food choices are affected by **more than just knowledge** price, convenience, experience, environment and social factors all matter.

Useful for our topic: It supports investigating **how technology could help students make healthier decisions while grocery shopping**, especially first-year students.